

CHAPTER 08

PAKISTAN AND COMITY OF NATIONS



Definition of Foreign Policy

Foreign policy refers to a country's strategy in dealing with other nations.

Pakistan's Foreign Policy is:

"The reflection of its domestic politics and the interaction with other sovereign states. It is based on principles and preferences that guide Pakistan's relations with the global community."

Guiding Principles of Pakistan's Foreign Policy

1. Protection of Freedom and Sovereignty

- Pakistan was created after immense sacrifices and deeply values its independence and sovereignty.
- It does not tolerate any threat to its autonomy and prioritizes national integrity in all external dealings.

2. Cordial Relations with Muslim Countries

- Pakistan consistently supports the unity of the Muslim Ummah and stands against aggression in Palestine, Kashmir, and Afghanistan.
- It maintains active involvement in the Organization of Islamic Conference (OIC).

3. Non-Interference in Internal Affairs

- Pakistan promotes mutual respect and peaceful coexistence by avoiding interference in the domestic matters of other nations.

4. Implementation of the UN Charter

- Pakistan is a committed member of the United Nations (UN) since its inception.
- It supports the UN Charter and global peace efforts under the UN umbrella.

5. Promotion of World Peace

- Pakistan advocates for peaceful conflict resolution through dialogue and negotiation instead of war.

6. Non-Alignment Policy

- Pakistan follows a policy of non-alignment, distancing itself from power blocs like the Cold War era's East and West alliances.
- It withdrew from SEATO and CENTO, and joined the Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) in 1979.

Conclusion

Pakistan's foreign policy is based on Islamic values, sovereignty, and peaceful coexistence. It strives to uphold justice, equality, and international cooperation in a peaceful global order.

United Nations Organization (UNO)

Introduction

Founded on October 24, 1945, after the devastating effects of World War II, the UNO was established to prevent future global conflicts and ensure peace.

Objectives of UNO

- Prevent war and maintain peace.
- Promote friendly relations among nations.
- Ensure human rights without discrimination.
- Advocate self-determination and respect among peoples.
- Encourage economic, social, and humanitarian development.

Main Organs of UNO

- General Assembly

- Security Council
- Economic and Social Council
- Trusteeship Council
- Secretariat
- International Court of Justice (ICJ)

Specialized Agencies

- UNICEF – Children's welfare
- UNESCO – Education, Science, Culture
- FAO – Food and Agriculture
- WHO – Global health
- ILO – Labour rights
- World Bank – Development and finance

Non-Aligned Movement (NAM)

Introduction

Formed in 1955, NAM includes countries that refused to join any power bloc during the Cold War.

Founding leaders include:

- Jawaharlal Nehru (India)
- Kwame Nkrumah (Ghana)
- Gamal Abdel Nasser (Egypt)
- Ahmed Sukarno (Indonesia)
- Marshal Tito (Yugoslavia)

Objectives

- Promote peace, cooperation, and unity among Afro-Asian countries.
- Address social, economic, and political challenges.
- Oppose colonialism and imperialism.

Pakistan and NAM

- Though actively involved since 1955, Pakistan officially joined in 1979.
- Previously, its membership in SEATO and CENTO restricted formal association.

South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC)

Introduction

Established on 7-8 December 1985 in Dhaka, SAARC promotes regional cooperation and development among South Asian countries.

Objectives

- Improve quality of life and welfare of the region's people.
- Accelerate economic, social, and cultural development.
- Promote mutual trust and collaboration.
- Work jointly in international forums on shared issues.

Member Countries

- Bangladesh
- Bhutan
- India
- Maldives
- Nepal
- Pakistan
- Sri Lanka

Organization of Islamic Conference (OIC)

Introduction

OIC is the largest Muslim organization, founded in Rabat (Morocco) in 1969, and restructured in Jeddah (1972). It unites 57 Islamic countries to collectively defend their interests.

Objectives

- Strengthen Muslim solidarity and fraternity.
- Support sovereignty and territorial integrity.
- Promote peace, justice, and cooperation.
- Defend Islamic values and minority rights globally.
- Support the Palestinian cause.
- Enhance economic, scientific, and technological development.

Main Organs

- Islamic Summit
- Council of Foreign Ministers
- Standing Committees
- Executive Committee
- Islamic Court of Justice
- Human Rights Commission
- General Secretariat, etc.

Standing Committees

- Al-Quds Committee
- Islamic Peace Committee
- COMIAC (Cultural Affairs)
- COMCEC (Economic Cooperation)
- COMSTECH (Scientific Cooperation)

Pakistan's Membership in International Organizations

Pakistan is an active member of several global and regional organizations, including:

- United Nations Organization (UNO)
- Non-Aligned Movement (NAM)
- Organization of Islamic Conference (OIC)
- Economic Cooperation Organization (ECO)
- South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC)
- CICA (Conference on Interaction and Confidence-Building Measures in Asia)

Pakistan's Foreign Policy

Introduction

Foreign policy refers to a nation's approach to managing its relations with other countries and international organizations. Pakistan's foreign policy is guided by the need to maintain its sovereignty, ensure regional stability, safeguard its security interests, and promote its economic development. Its policies also emphasize strengthening Islamic solidarity, defense capabilities, and global peace.

Key Objectives

The primary objectives of Pakistan's foreign policy include:

1. Safeguarding national sovereignty and ensuring territorial integrity.
2. Promoting peace and security, especially in the South Asian region.

3. Supporting the self-determination of Kashmiris.
4. Strengthening international alliances, particularly with Muslim countries, neighboring states, and major powers like China and the United States.
5. Promoting economic and trade relations, both regionally and globally.
6. Defending the Islamic identity, while emphasizing peaceful coexistence with all nations.

Guiding Principles

Pakistan's foreign policy is also guided by several principles, such as:

- Non-alignment: Avoiding any permanent alliances with major power blocs while maintaining friendly relations with all countries.
- Mutual respect and cooperation with neighboring countries.
- Support for Islamic unity through organizations like the OIC (Organization of Islamic Cooperation).
- Peaceful resolution of conflicts, especially with India and Afghanistan, and a commitment to global peace through organizations like the United Nations.

Relations with Muslim Countries

Overview

Pakistan's relations with Muslim countries are central to its foreign policy. It considers itself a bridge between the Islamic world and other global powers. Pakistan's foreign policy is based on promoting Islamic unity, supporting Palestinian rights, and fostering political, economic, and defense ties with Muslim nations.

Key Relationships with Muslim Countries

1. Saudi Arabia: Pakistan and Saudi Arabia share deep religious, political, and economic ties. Saudi Arabia is one of Pakistan's most important allies, providing both financial aid and economic support. The two countries collaborate on regional security issues and defense cooperation.

2. Turkey: Turkey and Pakistan have long-standing political and cultural ties. Both countries have cooperated in areas like military defense, trade, and education. Turkey also supports Pakistan's position on Kashmir, especially in international forums.

3. Iran: While Iran and Pakistan share cultural and religious ties, their relationship has faced challenges, especially over issues like border security and sectarian tensions. Nevertheless, both countries cooperate on economic matters, including energy, such as the Iran-Pakistan gas pipeline project.

4. UAE & Gulf States: Pakistan maintains a close relationship with the United Arab Emirates (UAE) and other Gulf countries, where millions of Pakistani workers reside. These countries provide substantial remittances, trade opportunities, and investment.

Role in OIC (Organization of Islamic Cooperation)

Pakistan plays a prominent role in the OIC, advocating for Palestinian rights, Muslim unity, and economic cooperation. It has hosted several OIC summits and uses this platform to raise issues related to the Muslim world and global peace.

India-Pakistan Relations

Introduction

India-Pakistan relations have been marked by tension and conflict since their independence in 1947. The primary sources of friction include the Kashmir dispute, water-sharing issues, and conflicts along their borders. Despite attempts at dialogue, the two countries have fought multiple wars (1948, 1965, 1971) and have continued to have issues

related to cross-border terrorism and military skirmishes.

The Kashmir Issue

The Kashmir conflict remains the core issue between India and Pakistan. After the partition in 1947, both countries claimed Kashmir, leading to the first war in 1948. Pakistan advocates for the right to self-determination for the Kashmiri people, whereas India considers Kashmir an integral part of its territory. The situation remains unresolved, and tensions often escalate over issues related to human rights violations and military presence in the region.

Diplomatic Relations

Relations have often been strained, especially after incidents like the Kargil war (1999) and the Pulwama attack (2019). Periods of peace have seen some diplomatic engagement through platforms like the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC), though significant breakdowns in communication have occurred after major incidents. Dialogue efforts have often been interrupted by terror attacks, border skirmishes, or domestic political factors in both countries.

Recent Developments

In 2019, India revoked Article 370 of its constitution, which granted special status to Jammu and Kashmir. This decision worsened relations between the two nations, with Pakistan downgrading diplomatic ties and launching global campaigns to raise the issue at forums like the United Nations.

China-Pakistan Relations

Introduction

China and Pakistan share a unique and strategic relationship that has been described as an "all weather friendship." The bilateral ties between the two countries are based on mutual interests in defense, economic development, and regional stability. This cooperation is underpinned by the shared goals of countering India's influence in the region and enhancing both nations' security.

Key Areas of Cooperation

1. China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC): The CPEC is a major component of the Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) launched by China. It involves extensive infrastructure development in Pakistan, including roads, railways, and ports, notably the Gwadar Port. This project aims to enhance trade connectivity between Pakistan, China, and other countries. CPEC has the potential to boost Pakistan's economic growth, improve infrastructure, and create new job opportunities.

2. Defense Cooperation: China and Pakistan have a strong military relationship. The two countries conduct joint military exercises and have collaborated on military technology, such as missile defense systems and aircraft production. China is also a significant arms supplier to Pakistan, contributing to its defense capabilities.

3. Diplomatic Support: On various global forums, particularly at the United Nations, China has consistently supported Pakistan's stance on Kashmir and regional security. Both countries view their cooperation as a counterbalance to India's growing influence in the region.

4. Economic and Technological Aid: China has invested significantly in Pakistan's infrastructure, including projects in telecom, energy, and education sectors. The trade between both countries is increasing, and Pakistan benefits from Chinese expertise in technology and development.

Conclusion

The China-Pakistan partnership is strategic and multi-dimensional. With the CPEC and ongoing defense cooperation, China is seen as a key partner in Pakistan's pursuit of economic progress and security enhancement. This relationship continues to evolve and strengthen in the face of regional challenges.